

**Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts
Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
May 29, 2013**

The meeting was called to order at 7:20 p.m. by Chairperson Falco. The following members were present: Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, Robert E. Skerry Jr., and Paulette Van der Kloot. (5 present 2 absent). Also present were Superintendent Roy Belson, Director of Administration and Finance Ann Giombetti, Director of Pupil Services Kathy Medaglio and SEPAC Chairperson Melanie McLaughlin.

All rose to salute the flag.

Chairperson Falco stated that the purpose of the meeting was to receive a pre budget report on special education and review requests for new items requested for FY 2013-2014.

Superintendent Belson explained that this meeting was a continuation from the previous Committee of the Whole on budget priorities. The Committee wanted to hear specifically from Director Medaglio regarding her budget concerns.

The Superintendent referred the Committee to the two line items from the previous week. He commented that the sped department was doing a good job but that with the new evaluation system moving into place and an administrative retirement there needed to be a reorganization and new additions to the department. Approximately \$223,000 new money would be needed.

He emphasized that the strong management of the sped department has helped to keep costs in check but the department needs new support to maintain that reality. The Superintendent handed out a news article from the Boston Globe as an example of the volatile nature of sped costs (see attached).

Ms. Medaglio began her presentation (see attached) which detailed the needs of department. There was substantial discussion.

The Committee rated the sped requests highly (1) and referred the discussion to budget. Since the bottom line has not been determined, no final action could be taken.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry seconded by Ms. Cugno the meeting was adjourned at 9:10 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,

John Falco
Vice Chairperson

